This last death provided 'Ala' al-Din an excuse he could not refuse. Ostensibly a thirst for vengeance but also a defiant personality, and doubtless a growing appetite for power and dominion – all underwritten by the Jam-Firuzkuh treasury replenished by the locality's commercial machinery – converged to impel 'Ala' al-Din Husain to deal a decisive blow to the Ghaznavids. In AH 544/1150 CE, while his eldest half-brother Fakhr al-Din Mas'ud remained at Kashi (Bamiyan), 'Ala' al-Din set out against the Ghaznavid sultan Bahram Shah and his forces to avenge the deaths of his three older brothers, two directly and one indirectly at the hands of the increasingly villainous Yaminis.[66] According to Juzjani's description of the confrontation's beginnings – unfolding upon the plains of Zamindawar, where both forces had converged – Bahram Shah had calculated that the mere mention of Indian elephants would deter 'Ala' al-Din from direct military engagement.[67] But the defiant Shansabani one-upped the Yamini's apotropaic threat, promising to match the elephants with the *Kharmil*, which was in reality a human "weapon" in the form of two champion Ghuri warriors whom 'Ala' al-Din ordered to bring down an elephant each. After the Kharmils' fulfillment of their ordered tasks and other disheartening setbacks, the Ghaznavid forces were defeated and Bahram Shah temporarily fled to India. Not satisfied with this defeat and still seeking thorough vengeance, 'Ala' al-Din immediately marched to Ghazna. The destruction he and his warriors unleashed on the Ghaznavid capital was also the fate of the royal sites of Lashkari Bazar and Bust, which he plundered and burned on his way back to Ghur from Zamindawar (cf. below).

Perhaps it was to be expected that, intoxicated with the avenging victory over Ghazna and its rulers, 'Ala' al-Din Husain shortly afterward openly challenged Saljuq authority, withholding the stipulated tribute of the famous Ghuri war equipment (among other items). Although not mentioned in Juzjani's *Tabaqat* – but recorded in Ibn al-Athir's *Kamil* – during the course of protracted military engagements in the vicinity of Herat, 'Ala' al-Din occupied this major commercial and cultural center long enough to issue coins with the Herat mint stamp.[68] But in a twist of events worthy of dramatization, in AH 547/1152/3 CE the well-known battle at Nab – a location between Chisht and Herat – determined 'Ala' al-Din's foreseeable future: the large-scale defection of Oghüz, Khalaj, and Turk horsemen from the Shansabanis to the Saljuqs brought about 'Ala' al-Din's defeat and even imprisonment within Sanjar's camp; although, the Shansabani ruler's quick wit earned him favor with Sanjar, who made him one of his boon companions and eventually released him.[69]

The reign of 'Ala' al-Din Husain and its significance, particularly for the Shansabanis of Firuzkuh, is gradually becoming clearer.[70] Recently, M. O'Neal (2016) presented coinage issued in the name of 'Ala' al-Din Husain that was probably minted at Ghazna *c.* AH 556/1161 CE, perhaps throwing a different light on this sultan's intended ambitions for the